Chloral Hydrate

FORM 500mg in 5ml Suspension

INDICATION Continuous enteral sedation under the direction of a consultant and reserved for clinical situations whereby alternative agents have been insufficient and/or are not appropriate

DOSE RANGE

Neonates (<1 month)	15-25mg/kg	EIGHT hourly* when required	Oral**
1 month-1 year	25mg/kg	EIGHT hourly* when required	Oral

*SIX hourly dosing can be used on Pharmacy advice or under the direction of a consultant. Maximum dose 30mg/kg/dose.

** If giving alimemazine and chloral hydrate concurrently, there must be an EIGHT hour gap between consecutive doses of each drug. Using an alternating schedule, it is then possible to give a dose of oral sedation every FOUR hours.

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS

- Contraindications: Acute Porphyria's, gastritis or gastric ulcers, severe cardiac disease.
- Avoid in renal and hepatic impairment.
- Caution in preterm and unwell babies. Avoid prolonged use. Review before considering regular dosing.
- Side effects: Cardiac toxicity, hypotension and gastrointestinal irritation.
- See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children

FURTHER INFORMATION Can be diluted with 1-2ml of sterile water before administration.

Use with caution in preterm and ill babies as accumulation can occur. Prescribe "AS REQUIRED" at the lowest possible dose, for the shortest duration possible and review daily.

Withdrawal symptoms are likely to occur when used for longer than 5 days. A stepwise wean is recommended.

Dosing updated subject to a recent MHRA Drug Safety Update and has adopted dosing recommendations from the Neonatal and Paediatric Pharmacist Group position statement (2025).

LICENSED STATUS Unlicensed 'Special' product

NEONATAL West of Scotland Drug Monographs
ORAL/OTHER ROUTES

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines

Consult local policy if applicable

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Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department.